

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major suit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

- 4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

- 3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

- 3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

- 3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

- 4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠7

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥2

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥3

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 5 4 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 9 7

♠ 6

♥ A K 9 7 2

♦ 8 7

♣ K Q 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ 10 4

♦ K 4 3 2

♣ 10 4 3

♠ A Q 9

♥ Q J 8 3

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ J 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ 7

NORTH bids 4 ♣ after SOUTH's Jacoby 2NT. The reason for this bid is just to describe her hand as having a side 5-card ♣ suit. NORTH knows the eventual contract will be some level of ♥s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand, but he would show ♦ control at this time if he had the Ace. He isn't strong enough to go past game to show the ♠ A, so he just bids 4 ♥.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 4
♥ K 8 7 5
♦ A J 4
♣ 6 4

♠ 3 2

♥ A Q 10 6

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ K 7 5

♣ A Q

♠ 10

♥ 4 3 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 10 9 8 3 2

WEST should not be tempted to use Jacoby 2NT with this hand. There are only 12 points, and the Limit Raise is a perfect way to show a 12 point support hand.

EAST has more than enough strength to bid game after WEST's limit raise. If WEST had mistakenly used a Jacoby 2NT response, EAST would probably have tried to reach slam, and perhaps gotten too high.

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 2

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 2
♥ 10 4 3 2
♦ 5 4 2
♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ J 10 8 6 3

♥ K J 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 5



♠ 7

♥ 9 6 5

♦ J 10 8 6

♣ A 8 7 6 4

♠ K Q 9 5 4

♥ A Q 8

♦ Q 9 7

♣ Q J

SOUTH bids 3NT to show a good hand with five ♠s.

NORTH shows his ♦ control, and SOUTH then shows her ♥ control.

A final check with Blackwood shows two Aces missing. Too bad.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	5 ♠		
All Pass			
5 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 2

♣ K Q

♠ 3

♥ 10 6 5 4 2

♦ A K 7

♣ 10 9 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 6

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ Q 9 4

♣ A 5

♠ 10 4

♥ J 7

♦ 10 8 5 3

♣ J 7 6 4 2

West

1 ♠

3 ♠

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ K

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4 ♣

4 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

WEST shows his 6-card ♠ suit by bidding 3♠.

EAST shows her ♣ control and WEST shows his ♥ control, but it seems neither has a control in ♦s.

So they stop in game.